

**CITY OF SOUTH MILWAUKEE PLAN COMMISSION
MEETING AGENDA**

Tuesday March 24, 2026 6:30 PM

Common Council Chambers, 2424 15th Avenue, South Milwaukee, WI.

1. Call meeting to order/roll call.
2. Approval of the January 27, 2026 meeting minutes.
3. Discussion of municipal zoning code amendments for regulations pertaining to:
 - a. Lot and building regulations for height and setbacks
 - b. Driveways and parking slabs
 - c. Signage
 - d. Stormwater Management
4. Update on Scott Crawford Bucyrus Campus development projects at 1100 Milwaukee Ave.
5. Schedule next meeting.
6. Adjourn.

Posted: 3/20/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

PLEASE NOTE: There is the potential that a quorum of the Common Council may be present at this meeting. Upon reasonable notice, a good faith effort will be made to accommodate the needs of disabled individuals through sign language, interpreters or other auxiliary aid at no cost to the individual to participate in public meetings. Due to the difficulty in finding interpreters, requests should be made as far in advance as possible, preferably a minimum of 48 hours. For additional information or to request this service, contact the South Milwaukee City Clerk at 762-2222, (FAX) 762-3272, or write to the ADA Coordinator, City Hall, 2424 15th Avenue, South Milwaukee, Wisconsin 53172. The City of South Milwaukee is TDD equipped and can be accessed by calling 768-8060

CITY OF SOUTH MILWAUKEE PLAN COMMISSION
MEETING MINUTES
Tuesday January 27, 2026

1. Call meeting to order/roll call.

The meeting was called to order at 6:30 p.m. Members present: Chair/Mayor Jim Shelenske, Chris Haslam, Renee Lindner, Nick Gates, Ald. David Bartoshevich, Ald. Brett Briesemeister. George Becker was absent and excused.

Also present: City Administrator Patrick Brever, Assistant City Administrator Katie Crosby, Interim City Administrator Jay Shambeau, and Economic Development Manager Ericka Lang.

2. Public Hearing on the application for a Conditional Use Permit Amendment for an existing pickleball recreational facility, requesting removal of alcohol restrictions and other conditions, at 305 N. Chicago Avenue, zoned Z-4 Urban Center Zone.

Chair Shelenske opened the public hearing at 6:31 pm, reading the public hearing notice and asking three times if anyone would like to speak. Staff confirmed no comments were received. At 6:32 pm Briesemeister moved to close the public hearing, seconded by Gates, all in favor.

3. Approval of the December 23, 2025 meeting minutes.

Haslam motioned to approve the minutes, seconded by Gates. All in favor.

4. Discussion/possible consideration of Conditional Use Permit Amendment for Premier Pickleball Complex at 305 N. Chicago, Zoned Z-3 General Urban Zone.

Lang presented the request from the owner, Guriqbal Sra, and confirmed the 11 conditions of the previously approved Conditional Use Permit have been satisfied. Mr. Sra confirmed after discussion that the event space would be for rent for birthday parties, baby/wedding showers, etc. He assured the commission that there would not be alcohol carry-ins and the events would not occupy or extend outside of the building. Mr. Sra would like to provide and serve liquor for events renting the space and during regular business hours. The request also includes changing the hours of operation to from 8am to midnight on weekends, and 8am to 10pm on weekdays.

Briesemeister made a motion to approve an amendment to the conditional use permit for the pickleball establishment at 305 N. Chicago Avenue for conditions #1 through #3, modifying the hours of operation and removing liquor license restrictions. Seconded by Shelenske, all in favor.

5. Discussion/possible consideration of development agreement and sale of municipal property 1701 10th Avenue for storage development Motorplex LLC, Zoned M-1 Manufacturing in Tax Increment District No. 5.

Brever provided an overview of the agreement, outlining its key terms, obligations, and timelines. Motorplex owner, Jodi Emanuele, was present. Motorplex plans to construct individual roll-up storage units to address storage and office space needs.

The development agreement would return the parcel to the tax roll. Gates, Briesemeister, Shelenske, and Lindner all expressed they were in full support of this agreement.

Briesemeister motioned to approve the development agreement with Motorplex, LLC for the sale of the city-owned property at 1701 10th Avenue, seconded by Shelenske, all in favor.

6. Economic Development Review

- a. Bucyrus grants**
- b. Business activities**
- c. Economic development projects**
 - i. Status of development projects**
 - ii. RenewTowns business pitch by UW-Whitewater**

Lang provided an Economic Development Annual Report for 2025, summarizing ongoing and upcoming projects and grants, business and storefront vacancies, and highlighting key milestones throughout the city.

7. Schedule next meeting (February 24, 2026 at 6:30 pm)

8. Adjourn.

Briesemeister motioned to adjourn the meeting at 7:26 p.m., seconded by Bartoshevich. Vote unanimous.

Recorded by

Heidi Eichner
Recording Secretary



ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT MEMO

Date: **March 20, 2026**

To: **Plan Commission**

From: Economic Development Manager Ericka Lang, City Engineer Genevieve Stollenwerk and Building Inspector Steve Petery

Meeting Date: **March 24, 2026**

Subject: **Proposed Zoning Chapter Amendments – Discussion Meeting 1**

A. Background/Rationale

Last year the zoning code was completely rewritten. During the rewrite process, many items were thoroughly discussed and evaluated and others were reviewed at a higher level. As staff utilizes the code, some areas require further review.

There are various code sections that staff is seeking input before providing comprehensive recommendations.

B. Key Issues for Discussion

1. Building heights

The current height regulations rely on multiple calculations and layers of contextual language, making them difficult for contractors and residents to interpret when determining the allowable height of a new building. The code blends factors such as right-of-way type and width, the height of adjacent buildings, and average minimum setbacks. It also allows additional height when a building is set farther back from a property line.

Streamlining these standards would reduce the amount of staff time spent explaining the code to applicants before submittal and during project review.

2. Accessory structure setbacks

The setbacks for accessory structures on corner lots is not easily understood. The code identifies street setbacks and side and rear setbacks. It does not differentiate front or street side for accessory structures. And, the contextual setback language applies only to primary structures.

In the Z-2 and Z-3 zones, accessory structures must be “20-feet + principal building setback”. For corner properties, this is too restrictive for street side yard setbacks.

The code does not allow accessory structures in front yards or in front of adjacent primary structures.

3. Driveways and parking slabs

Driveway language is located in the zoning chapter and in chapter 23 Public Peace and Safety. Most of section 23.15 should be relocated to the zoning chapter. It also contradicts some of the zoning code.

The priority for discussion is whether the code should allow front yard parking slabs and what are reasonable driveway widths in front yards.

Since 2008 sect 23.15 only permits driveways and no other improved parking areas except by administrative review. It also limits front or rear yards for parking and driveways to 40%. The zoning code has overall impervious lot percentages.

4. Signage

For discussion:

- a. Revising wall signs language for multi-tenant buildings/strip malls
- b. Standards for non-business signage for multiple building complexes and varying uses.
- c. Limitations for freestanding sign heights
- d. Flagpoles- maximum 3 poles and height of flag 20% of pole length. Code does not provide max height.

Staff comments are included in the attachment

5. Pre- and Post Construction Stormwater

Refer to Engineers memo

C. Fiscal Impact

Staff is editing the zoning chapter changes at no additional cost. See engineering memo for stormwater amendments.

D. Requested Action

No action at this time

E. Attachments

- LOT AND BUILDING
 - Code markup Lot and Building Regulations Sect 15.16
 - Example illustration of proposed height changes
 - Pictures of residential housing with varying densities
 - *an illustration of setback examples will be provided at the meeting
- DRIVEWAYS
 - Code sections and staff comments
 - Aerials of 6 existing homes and driveways in the city
 - Code markup of driveways and parking
 - Franklin and Fond du Lac codes on driveways/parking slabs
- SIGNAGE
 - Code section with staff comments
- Engineer memo

BUILDING HEIGHTS AND ACCESSORY BUILDING SETBACKS

MARKUP V1 BUILDING SETBACKS

§ 15.16. Lot and building regulations.

A. Lot and building regulations

Table II-2: Lot and Building Regulations						
	Z-1	Z-2	Z-3	Z-4	M-1	PDD
Lot Occupation						
Lot Width (feet)	Not applicable	60 min. 110 max.	30 min. 90 max.	180 max.	900 max.	Established during district adoption
Maximum Impervious Coverage (%)	Not applicable	50	60	90	90	
Setbacks — Principal Building						
Street Setback (Principal) (feet)	Regulations of most restrictive abutting district	24 min.	6 min. 18 max.	2 min. 12 max.	24 min.	Established during district adoption
Street Setback (Secondary) (feet)		8 min.	6 min. 18 max.	2 min. 12 max.	12 min.	
Side Setback (feet)		8 min.	3 min. Arterial streets: 0	0 min. 24 max.	12 min.	
Rear Setback (feet)		8 min.	3 min.	3 min.	12 min.	
Minimum Frontage Buildout (%)		40	60	80	40	
Setbacks — Accessory Building						
Street Setback (Principal)(feet)	Regulations of most restrictive abutting district	20 min. + principal building setback	20 min. + principal building setback	40 max. from rear property line	20 min. + principal building setback	Established during district adoption
Street Setback (Secondary) (feet)	Regulations of most restrictive abutting district	Refer to 15.16C	Refer to 15.16C	Refer to 15.16C	Refer to 15.16C	

§ 15.16

SOUTH MILWAUKEE CODE

§ 15.16

Side Setback (feet)	Regulations of most restrictive abutting district	6	3	3	6
Rear Setback (feet)	Regulations of most restrictive abutting district	6	3	3	6

B. Contextual street-yard building setbacks. If a primary structure exists on any immediately adjacent parcel, not including parcels separated by a public right-of-way, the street-yard setback for the subject parcel shall be the average of the minimum street-yard setback of the subject zone and the setback of the adjacent primary structure(s). In no circumstance shall the street-yard setback exceed the maximum street-yard setback of the subject zone.

C. Accessory buildings.

(1) Street side yard. Accessory buildings shall maintain a minimum setback from the street side lot line equal to the required front yard setback of the adjoining lot that fronts on that street. No accessory building on a corner lot may be located within the area that would constitute the front yard of the adjacent property located around the corner, as determined by the zoning district of that adjacent property.

(+)(2) Accessory buildings must be separated by a minimum distance of 10 feet from the principal building on the lot.

B-D. Setback encroachments. Open or enclosed fire escapes, terraces, and unenclosed stairways may project into a side or rear yard not more than four feet; provided that they are not closer than three feet to any lot line. Uncovered stairs and landings may project up to four feet into the principal street-yard setback.

15.16 Lot and building regulations.

D. Height regulations. ~~When multiple ratios apply to a property, the City shall limit the building height to the lowest height at any given point on the property for the given ratios. All buildings may increase in height by one foot for every foot into the property perpendicular to the property line.~~ The City limits building heights to the maximum principal building height listed in Table II-3 based on the right-of-way type adjacent to the subject property. When the subject property abuts multiple different right-of-way types, the greatest maximum principal building height shall control.

Table II-3: Height Regulations				
Right-of-Way Type	Principal Building Height	Accessory Building Height	Right-of-Way Width	Example Maximum Principal Building Height (feet)
Major Arterial	4	0.3	4	120-foot height allowance at property line: 120-foot right-of-way
Minor Arterial	0.7	0.3	4	84-foot height allowance at property line: 120-foot right-of-way
Collector	0.5	0.25	4	40-foot height allowance at property line: 80-foot right-of-way
Local	0.33	0.15	4	22-foot height allowance at property line: 66-foot right-of-way
Alleys, pedestrian connections, and multi-use pathways	4	4	4	20-foot height allowance at property line: 20-foot right-of-way 24

- (1) Accessory building height limitations. No property owner may build an accessory building taller than the primary structure, ~~or~~ 24 feet, ~~or the accessory building height ratio contained within Table II-3: Height Regulations,~~ whichever is less.
- (2) Contextual building heights. If a ~~primary structure exists~~ principal building abuts the subject property on any immediately adjacent ~~parcel~~ property, not including ~~parcels~~ properties separated by a ~~public~~ right-of-way, the maximum principal building height shall not exceed the ~~following~~ multipliers within Table II-4.
- (3) Calculating building heights. Suppose a subject property lies along a minor arterial street, and a principal building exists on an adjacent property within a Z-4 district that is 24 feet tall.
- (a) Example 1: Basic Calculation. The maximum principal building height for the subject property is 96 feet $(\text{Add})et \times 4.0 = 96 \text{ feet}$, because the Z-4 contextual building height multiplier from Table II-4 reduces the subject property's allowable principal building height to a value less than the Right-of-Way Type limits from Table II-3.
- (b) Example 2: Different Adjacent Zone. If the same 24-foot principal building exists on an adjacent property within a Z-2 district, the maximum principal building height for the subject property is 36 feet $(\text{Add})et \times (\text{Add}) 36 \text{ feet}$, because the Z-2 contextual building height multiplier from Table II-4 reduces the subject property's allowable principal building height to a value less than the Right-of-Way Type limits from Table II-3.
- (c) Example 3: Different Right-of-Way Type. If the subject property lies along a collector street, the maximum principal building height is 80 feet, because the Right-of-Way Type from Table II-3 limits the maximum principal building height to a value less than the Contextual Building Height Limit in Table II-4.

Table II-4: Contextual Building Height Limits	
Adjacent Zone	Increase in Stories Above Structure on Adjacent Parcel
Z-1	No limit
Z-2	1.50x
Z-3	2.0x
Z-4	4.0x
M-1	No limit

- (4) ~~(3)~~ Measuring Height. The City measures height as the vertical distance from the average ground elevation along the structure's base to the highest point of the subject structure. The average ground elevation is the midpoint between the highest and lowest ground elevations along the exterior building wall.
- (a) ~~(4)~~ Exceptions. Chimneys, cooling towers, elevators, necessary mechanical appurtenances, and public utility structures not intended for human occupancy may exceed the limitations of this chapter.

EXAMPLE ILLUSTRATIONS OF PROPOSED ZONING HEIGHT CHANGES

NEW CODE:

Zone	Z-2	Z-3	Z-4
Multiplier	1.5	2	4
if adjacent principal building		<i>Not to Scale</i>	
Max Principal Building Heights			
Arterial streets: 120-ft			
Collector streets: 80-ft			
Local streets: 66 ft			

Existing Parcels Examples

1200 – 1218 Milwaukee Z-4, Arterial Street
Multiplier 4x 38-ft = 154-ft. MAX HEIGHT 120-Ft

120-ft Max
8-9 stories

38-ft
3 stories

28-ft
2 stories

32-ft
2.5 stories

Milwaukee Av

12th Av

2318 10th Z-4, Arterial Street
MAX HEIGHT 120-Ft, Multiplier not used b/c ROW

120-ft Max
8-9 stories

Alley
Marquette Av

Alley

3-story
apartments

10th Av

EXAMPLES OF GENTLE DENSITY – INCREMENTAL INCREASES



2/20/2026 South Milwaukee

Staff Comments South Milwaukee Codes for Residential Driveways & Parking Areas

Relevant code language **highlighted**. Staff comments in **[red]**

15.16 Lots and Building Regulations

Maximum Lot Impervious Coverage:

Z-1 NA	Z-2 50%	Z-3 60%	Z-4 90%	M-1 90%
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15.22 Parking and Loading Areas

G. Use of motor vehicle parking areas. Property **owners may only park licensed, operable motor vehicles in outdoor off-street motor vehicle parking spaces**. They may not work on any motor in any outdoor motor vehicle parking space. They **may not use any motor vehicle parking spaces for storing**, displaying, or selling any goods or materials unless specifically approved by the Zoning Administrator

H. Parking area ratios

(1) R-Uses requires one parking space per unit

I. Parking area layout and design. Property owners shall design and lay out all off-street motor vehicle parking areas and drive aisles per this subsection.

(1) Location. Property owners shall place all **off-street motor vehicle parking areas behind buildings** where possible. The City prohibits parking lots larger than 12 spaces between buildings and the street. Where alley access is impossible, property owners may place parking lots to the side of the primary structure.

(2) Ingress and egress. Property owners must design all areas serving all uses, except R-1 uses on a local street, to allow vehicles to enter and exit streets and cross public sidewalks in a forward motion.

(3) Alley access. Property owners shall access all parking areas from an alley if the lot has legal access to an alley. Where alley access is impossible, property owners shall prioritize vehicular access to sites from local streets.

(6) **Driveway width. The maximum width of driveways at the point of connection to the street is 24 feet for two-way travel and 12 feet for one-way travel.**

[Does not factor residential 2 – 3-car garages.]

(7) Number of access points. The City restricts each property to one vehicular access point except where, in the written opinion of a licensed traffic engineer or the Fire Chief, life safety requires separate ingress and egress.

STORAGE USES — Storage uses include, among others, the use of a building or structure, or a portion thereof, for storage not classified as an H use. A room or space used for storage purposes that is accessory to another occupancy shall be classified as part of that occupancy.

VEHICULAR USE AREA — A vehicular use area is an outdoor area on a lot used for the storage and operation of motor vehicles, including parking lots, vehicle storage areas, vehicle display areas, loading areas, driveways, and drive-through lanes.

[Driveways can be used for storage. Parking slabs are not driveways]

Chapter 23 Public Peace and Safety, 23-15 Vehicular parking and junk automobiles

F. Prohibited parking areas. [Added 12-2-2008 by Ord. No. 1983]

(1) It shall be unlawful to park any vehicle, trailer, or equipment, as defined herein on any lawn or grass, or other yard that is not an improved parking area as defined in Subsection A(3) on any residentially zoned property or property however zoned if it is used for residential purposes.

(a) Vehicles or equipment shall include house trailers (campers); utility trailers, mobile homes, motor vehicles, trucks, passenger vehicles, motor homes, motorcycles, other trailers, boats, construction equipment, machinery, or any parts of the above.

(2) Limits of improved parking areas shall be as defined herein or under Chapter 15 (Zoning Code). [Revise below language and relocate to Ch 15.]

(a) Front, side, and rear yards of the primary structure shall not be used as an improved parking area except for a driveway extending from the public street or alley to a garage. The front yard of the primary dwelling shall be lawn or landscaping area, except for walkways connecting from sidewalks, roads or driveways to front of dwellings.

[Discuss allowing side yard parking slab. Zoning requires all off-street parking behind buildings where possible. Revise and relocate to Zoning.]

(b) The total area of a yard used for parking and driveway purposes shall not exceed 40 % of the larger of the required minimum or actual front or rear yard setback area, and shall not exceed 24 feet in width.

[Ch 15 has max impervious coverage and also has driveway width at point of contact limited to 12' or 24'. Discuss max front yard impervious %]

(c) Driveways and improved parking areas shall be a minimum of two feet from a side (or rear) property line, except as noted herein.

[No changes. Relocate to zoning]

(d)

[1] Where a property has frontage and access to a public alley, a driveway or improved parking shall only be from the alley to the rear yard.

[Delete - Currently in zoning code]

[2] On a corner lot, improved parking shall only be from one side.

[Delete - Currently in zoning code]

(3) Exceptions.

(a) Single family or two family dwellings that have side entry garages in front of a dwelling may exceed coverage by administrative review.

[Remove. Zoning impervious applies]

(b) The City may approve an increase in front yard driveway coverage by administrative review when the increase would meet the intent of the code or where ordinance standards cannot be reasonably applied to the lot or create an unreasonable hardship based on the characteristics of the premises and/or land. A hardship cannot be based on the number or type of vehicles owned by the occupants or owners. As part of such review, the owner or applicant may be required to add screening around the driveway to help hide the parking area and vehicles from view of adjacent properties or from the street. The property owner or applicant may use a privacy fence, landscaping, or other means to meet the requirements.

[Zoning allows driveways in front yards. Zoning also has 10% adjustments]

(c) Properties that exceed the maximum coverage as of the date of this ordinance shall not expand the improved parking area. Property owners exceeding the maximum shall not be required to remove permanently paved improved areas and may use such areas for parking.

(4) Responsibility. The owner or lessee of any vehicle or equipment defined under Subsection F(1)(a) and the owner, agent or tenant of any premises within any residential zoning district upon which such vehicle or equipment are parked, stored or maintained, shall be individually responsible for complying with the provisions of § 23.15F.

(5) Penalties and enforcement.

(a) Any person, firm or corporation who violates the provisions of § 23.15F(1) shall, upon written notice from the Police Department, remove the vehicle or equipment within 10 days of the date of the notice or shall pay a forfeiture of not less than \$10 nor more than \$200 for each offense, and each day that such violation continues shall be considered as a separate offense.

(b) The City engineer and/or the Building Inspector shall be primarily responsible for reviewing compliance with § 23.15F(2) and enforcement of provisions as it pertains to limits of improved parking for new construction or expansion of improved parking for previously developed properties.

EXAMPLES OF LOCAL AERIALS OF EXISTING SINGLE FAMILY HOME DRIVEWAYS

Manistique



24-ft wide driveway approach

Driveway

Single side yard parking slab

12-ft driveway approach

24-ft wide tapered
driveway

Front yard parking slab

Manitowoc



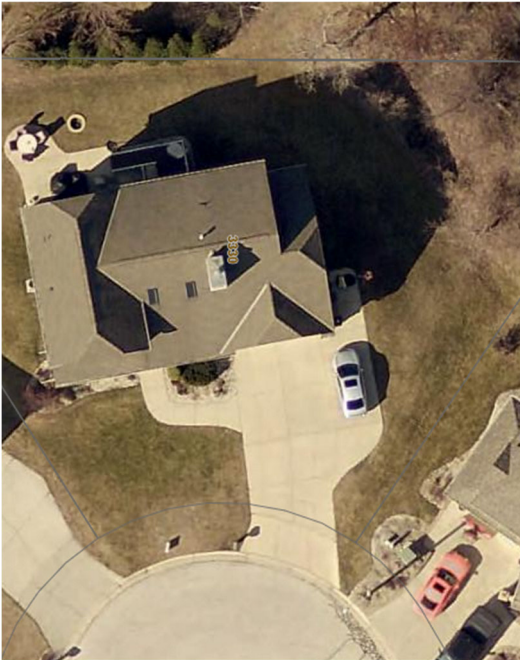
12-ft driveway approach

24-ft wide tapered driveway

Front and side yard parking
slab

EXAMPLES OF LOCAL AERIALS OF EXISTING SINGLE FAMILY HOME DRIVEWAYS

Blake Court



24-ft driveway approach
30-ft wide tapered driveway
Front and side yard parking slab

Drexel



24-ft driveway approach &
driveway
Front parking slab

Blake



24-ft driveway approach
48-ft wide tapered driveway
2-car front and side yard parking
slab

Draft Markup v1: Codes for Residential Driveways and Motor Vehicle Parking Areas

15.22 Parking and Loading Areas

G. Use of motor vehicle parking areas. Property owners may only park licensed, operable motor vehicles in outdoor off-street motor vehicle parking spaces. They may not work on any motor in any outdoor motor vehicle parking space. They may not use any motor vehicle parking spaces for storing, displaying, or selling any goods or materials unless specifically approved by the Zoning Administrator

H. Parking area ratios

(1) R-Uses requires one parking space per unit

I. Parking area layout and design. Property owners shall design and lay out all off-street motor vehicle parking areas and drive aisles per this subsection.

(1) Location. Property owners shall place all off-street motor vehicle parking areas behind buildings where possible. The City prohibits parking lots larger than 12 spaces between buildings and the street. Where alley access is impossible, property owners may place parking lots to the side of the primary structure.

(2) Ingress and egress. Property owners must design all areas serving all uses, except R-1 uses on a local street, to allow vehicles to enter and exit streets and cross public sidewalks in a forward motion.

(3) Alley access. Property owners shall access all parking areas from an alley if the lot has legal access to an alley. Where alley access is impossible, property owners shall prioritize vehicular access to sites from local streets.

(4) Parking dimensions. Property owners shall design all parking spaces to the following dimensions.

Table IV-4 Parking Stall Dimensions

Stall Angle	Stall Width	Stall Length	Aisle Width
0° Off Street	9.0	20.0	12.0
45°	9.0	17.0	11.0
60°	9.0	17.0	15.0
75°	9.0	17.0	20.0
90°	9.0	17.0	22.0

(5) Oversized and compact spaces. Property owners may provide oversized or compact spaces with modified sizes as approved by the Zoning Administrator so long as the total number of spaces is not greater than 20% of the total number of off-street motor vehicle parking spaces.

(6) Driveways

(a) Driveway width. The maximum width of driveways at the point of connection to the street right of way is 24 feet for two-way travel and 12 feet for one-way travel.

i. For R1 uses, driveways shall not exceed 24 feet in width at the property line. Driveways shall be the width of the garage, as measured from the garage door(s) plus an additional three (3) feet on either side of the garage doors(s).

(b) Driveways and improved parking areas shall be a minimum of two feet from a street side or rear property line.

(7) Number of access points. The City restricts each property to one vehicular access point except where, in the written opinion of a licensed traffic engineer or the Fire Chief, life safety requires separate ingress and egress.

(8) Vertical clearance. Property owners shall provide at least seven feet of vertical clearance above all parking spaces.

(9) Surfacing. Property owners shall surface all areas with asphalt, concrete, or other hard, dust-free surfaces approved by the Zoning Administrator.

(10) Tandem and stacked parking. Property owners may utilize tandem or stacked parking areas when they assign those spaces to the same dwelling unit.

(11) Curbs and barriers. Property owners must provide six-inch curbs and gutters, wheel stops, or other physical barriers for all areas abutting setbacks, landscaped areas, and adjoining property lines. They shall locate all barriers parallel to the protected area and perpendicular to the angle of parking at least two feet from the edge of the protected area.

J. R use heavy vehicle parking limitations. Property owners may only park vehicles over 14,000 pounds gross vehicle weight rating on lots occupied by R-1 and R-2 uses in a completely enclosed building.

15.28 Terms defined

DRIVEWAY — A private road or paved area giving access from a public way leading to a house, garage or building.

PARKING SPACE — An unobstructed area exclusively for the temporary storage of one automobile.

PATIO — An accessory paved area less than six inches in height which may go to the property boundary.

STORAGE USES — Storage uses include, among others, the use of a building or structure, or a portion thereof, for storage not classified as an H use. A room or space used for storage purposes that is accessory to another occupancy shall be classified as part of that occupancy.

VEHICULAR USE AREA — A vehicular use area is an outdoor area on a lot used for the storage and operation of motor vehicles, including parking lots, vehicle storage areas, vehicle display areas, loading areas, driveways, and drive-through lanes.

Chapter 23 Public Peace and Safety

23-15 Vehicular parking and junk automobiles

F. Prohibited parking areas.

(1) It shall be unlawful to park any vehicle, trailer, or equipment, as defined herein on any lawn or grass, or other yard that is not an improved parking area as defined in Subsection A(3) on any residentially zoned property or property however zoned if it is used for residential purposes.

(a) Vehicles or equipment shall include house trailers (campers); utility trailers, mobile homes, motor vehicles, trucks, passenger vehicles, motor homes, motorcycles, other trailers, boats, construction equipment, machinery, or any parts of the above.

(2) Limits of improved parking areas shall be as defined ~~herein or~~ under Chapter 15 (Zoning Code).

~~(a) Front, side, and rear yards of the primary structure shall not be used as an improved parking area except for a driveway extending from the public street or alley to a garage. The front yard of the primary dwelling shall be lawn or landscaping area, except for walkways connecting from sidewalks, roads or driveways to front of dwellings.~~

~~(b) The total area of yard used for parking and driveway purposes shall not exceed 40 [%] of the larger of the required minimum or actual front or rear yard setback area, and shall not exceed 24 feet in width.~~

~~(c) Driveways and improved parking areas shall be a minimum of two feet from a side (or rear) property line, except as noted herein.~~

~~(d)~~

~~[1] Where a property has frontage and access to a public alley, a driveway or improved parking shall only be from the alley to the rear yard.~~

~~[2] On a corner lot, improved parking shall only be from one side.~~

~~(3) Exceptions.~~

~~(a) Single family or two family dwellings that have side entry garages in front of a dwelling may exceed coverage by administrative review.~~

~~(b) The City may approve an increase in front yard driveway coverage by administrative review when the increase would meet the intent of the code or where ordinance standards cannot be reasonably applied to the lot or create an unreasonable hardship based on the characteristics of the premises and/or land. A hardship cannot be based on the number or type of vehicles owned by the occupants or owners. As part of such review, the owner or applicant may be required to add screening around the driveway to help hide the parking area and vehicles from view of adjacent properties or from the street. The property owner or applicant may use a privacy fence, landscaping, or other means to meet the requirements.~~

~~(c) Properties that exceed the maximum coverage as of the date of this ordinance shall not expand the improved parking area. Property owners exceeding the maximum shall not be required to remove permanently paved improved areas and may use such areas for parking.~~

(34) Responsibility. The owner or lessee of any vehicle or equipment defined under Subsection F(1)(a) and the owner, agent or tenant of any premises within any residential zoning district upon which such vehicle or equipment are parked, stored or maintained, shall be individually responsible for complying with the provisions of § 23.15F.

(45) Penalties and enforcement.

(a) Any person, firm or corporation who violates the provisions of § 23.15F(1) shall, upon written notice from the Police Department, remove the vehicle or equipment within 10 days of the date of the notice or shall pay a forfeiture of not less than \$10 nor more than \$200 for each offense, and each day that such violation continues shall be considered as a separate offense.

(b) The City engineer and/or the Building Inspector shall be primarily responsible for reviewing compliance with § 23.15F(2) and enforcement of provisions as it pertains to limits of improved parking for new construction or expansion of improved parking for previously developed properties.

[Added 12-2-2008 by Ord. No. 1983]

Examples Driveway/Parking Codes, residential

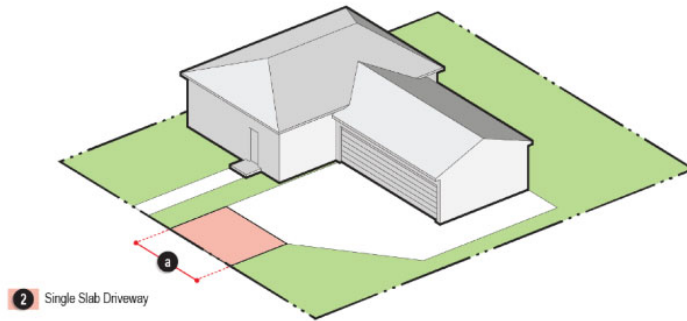
Franklin, WI § 15-5-02 Driveways.

D. Single-Family and Duplex Driveway Standards. A single slab or ribbon driveway from the property line to legal, on-site parking shall be provided and shall be in conformance with the following criteria.

1. Limit of One. One (1) single slab or ribbon driveway and one (1) curb cut shall be permitted per seventy-five (75) feet of lot frontage.

2. Single-Slab Driveway Design Standards.

a. Single-slab driveways shall not exceed twenty-four (24) feet in width at the property line.

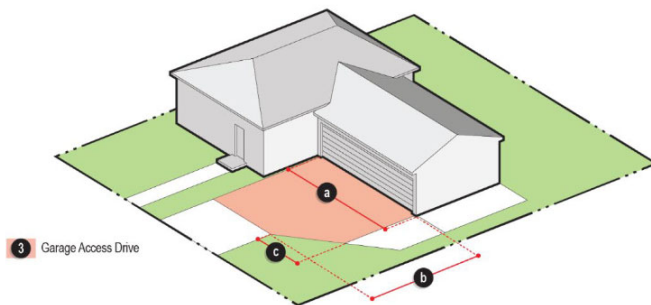


3. Garage Access Drive. A garage access drive is permitted and shall meet the standards below.

a. Width. The maximum width of a garage access drive shall be the width of the garage, as measured from the garage door(s) plus an additional three (3) feet on either side of the garage door(s).

b. Length. The maximum length of a garage access drive shall be twenty (20) feet from the garage doors.

c. Taper. The garage access drive shall taper, within ten (10) feet, back to the maximum driveway width.



4. Parking Pad.

a. Limit of One. A garage access drive may be extended to include one (1) parking pad.

b. Configuration.

i. A parking pad shall be a minimum of nine (9) feet and a maximum of ten (10) feet in width.

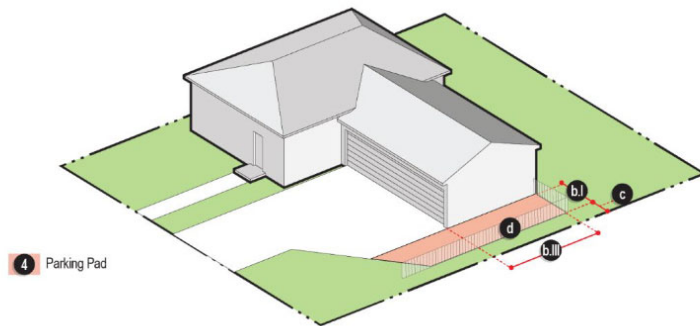
ii. The portion of the parking pad adjacent to the garage access drive shall have a maximum length of twenty (20) feet, as measured from the front facade line of the garage. A minimum seven (7) foot taper shall be included in the twenty (20) foot maximum.

iii. The portion of the parking pad adjacent to the garage shall have a maximum length equal to the depth of the garage, as measured from the front facade line of the garage.

c. Location. The parking pad shall be set back a minimum of five (5) feet from any side property line.

d. Screening. A fully opaque fence with a minimum height of six (6) feet shall be constructed in the side yard abutting the parking pad.

e. Surfacing. A parking pad may be surfaced with asphalt, concrete, grass, gravel, or a permeable paving system. The first one-half (1/2) inch of runoff over the entire surface shall be treated with green infrastructure if the parking pad is surfaced with asphalt or concrete.



Fond du Lac, WI - requires min 2-foot setback from property lines

[§ 720-79 Off-street parking.](#)

C. Area and access.

(2) An off-street parking space shall be independently accessible to a drive aisle or driveway that provides access to a street or alley. A tandem parking configuration for one parking space in a garage or carport and one uncovered parking space in front of the garage or carport within the allowable driveway area may be used to meet the on-site parking requirement for a residential use.

(3) In addition to the allowable driveway of a one- or two-family dwelling, one uncovered parking space is permitted alongside an attached or detached garage, provided that such parking space is not located between the building and the front lot line, is at least eight feet from a side and/or rear lot line, constructed to not interfere with drainage of the property or any abutting property, and is screened with landscape plantings or fencing. For a corner lot or through lot, an uncovered parking space shall not be located in any yard area that abuts a street. The size of an uncovered parking space alongside a garage shall not exceed 12 feet in width and 18 feet in depth.

(4) For one- or two-family dwellings located along streets where parking is prohibited on either side of the public-right-of-way and where no alley access is present, an additional off-street paved parking space may be allowed. An off-street parking space no larger than five feet wide and 18 feet long and located parallel, adjacent and contiguous to the main existing driveway, but not to include the egress and public right-of-way may be allowed, provided:

(a) An access less than nine feet wide which has a grade slope of 15% or less in slope to the rear is not available.

(b) The parking space shall be installed behind the front building lines (extended) of the structure.

(c) The existing driveway width is equal to or less than the width of the single-car garage, but not wider than 15 feet.

(d) The pavement setbacks shall be at least two feet from all property lines. No minimum pavement setbacks for properties with shared driveways.

(e) When [§ 720-79C\(4\)\(a\)](#) and (b) cannot be met, then a parking space may be located between the public right-of-way and the structure in a front yard or street yard.

SIGNAGE

COMMENTS FOR SIGN CODE REVISIONS v1

§ 15.21. Signs. [Amended 8-5-2025 by Ord. No. 2283]

- A. Purpose and intent. This section's intent is to provide comprehensive and balanced sign regulations that will preserve the right of free speech and expression; avoid excessive levels of visual clutter or distraction that are potentially harmful to traffic and pedestrian safety, property values, business opportunities, and community appearance; and ensure that signs are well-constructed, maintained, and expressive of the identity of individual activities and the community.
- B. Compliance. No person shall locate, erect, move, reconstruct, extend, enlarge, convert, or structurally alter any sign without conforming to the provisions of this chapter and a sign permit, unless exempted from sign permit requirements under Subsection C or G.
- C. Exemptions. The City exempts the following signs from the regulations contained in this chapter.
- (1) A sign posted by a governmental agency.
 - (2) A sign integrated into or on an automatic teller machine, coin-operated machine, or vending machine.
 - (3) Fuel price signs on lots occupied by fueling stations, as required by Wis. Stats., § 100.18(8).
 - (4) A sign carried by a person.
 - (5) Street addresses and numbers.
 - (6) Murals and other works of art that are not related by logo, pictorial depiction, or other means to the advertisement of any product or service or the identification of any business.
 - (7) Holiday lights and decorations containing no commercial message and displayed during the appropriate time of year.
 - (8) Flags, up to a maximum of three per lot or parcel. The length of the hoist side of any flag shall not exceed 20% of the vertical height of the pole. Property owners must fly U.S. flags in accordance with protocol established by the U.S. Congress. The City considers any flag that does not meet these requirements a sign subject to the requirements of this chapter.
- [Discuss limiting # of flag poles and pole heights. As currently written, a 4-ft hoist is a 24-ft max pole.
St. Frances – max 35 ft
Cudahy – can't exceed height max of district
Wauwatosa- can be in setbacks. May exceed building heights]
- D. Abandoned signs. Property owners shall remove all signs, sign messages, and supporting structures, as applicable, when the related use concludes or it is dilapidated beyond repair under the provisions of Wis. Stats., § 66.0413. If the owner fails to remove such signs, the Zoning Administrator may follow § 15.12.
- E. Construction and maintenance.

- (1) Wind pressure and dead load requirements. Property owners shall design and construct all signs and supporting structures to withstand wind pressure of not less than 40 pounds per square foot of area (1,916.74 Pa) and to receive dead loads as required in the Building Code.
- (2) Protection of the public. The City permits temporary occupancy of a sidewalk, street, or other public property during the construction, removal, repair, alteration, or maintenance of a sign provided the applicant ropes off or isolates the temporarily occupied space.
- (3) Maintenance. The owner of any sign shall keep the sign and supporting structure in good maintenance and repair which includes restoring, repainting, or replacing worn or damaged legally existing signage to its original permitted condition. Property owners shall maintain the signage premises in a clean, sanitary, and inoffensive condition, free and clear of all obnoxious substances, rubbish, and weeds.
- (4) Construction. Property owners shall construct all sign elements in materials resistant to rust, rot, or other degradation. Property owners shall attach all sign elements to support structures or adjacent buildings via methods approved by the Building Inspector.
- (5) Prohibited attachment areas. No property owner may attach, fasten, or anchor any sign element to any fire escape, fire ladder, or standpipe. No sign element may hinder or prevent ingress or egress through any door, window, or fire escape or hinder or prevent the Fire Department from raising or placing of ladders against a building.
- (6) Electrical permits. Signs with electrical wiring require a separate electrical permit from the Building Inspector. No property owner may serve any sign with electricity via overhead electrical wiring.
- (7) Unmovable base. If the Zoning Administrator approves a sign with external illumination, the property owner shall mount the illumination fixture on a permanent unmovable base to prevent the tampering or redirection of the fixture from the permitted configuration.

F. General provisions.

- (1) Signs resembling other signs. No sign shall resemble, imitate, or approximate the shape, size, form, or color of railroad or traffic signs, signals, or devices and shall not obstruct or interfere with the effectiveness of railroad or traffic signs, signals, or devices.
- (2) Obstructing signs. No property owner shall locate a sign that obstructs or interferes with traffic visibility, nor illuminate it in a way that causes glare or impairs driver visibility upon public ways.
- (3) Illuminated signs. Property owners may illuminate signs provided they, other than public traffic control signs, have no elements that flash, blink, rotate, or pulsate. All illuminated signage must meet the outdoor lighting standards of § 15.24. The City shall not consider signs that include changeable copy reader boards and electronic message boards (EMBs) flashing or pulsating signs, provided they comply with all other applicable provisions of this section.

G. Signs permitted without a permit. The City permits the following signs without a permit.

- (1) Sale, lease, or rent signage. The City permits temporary freestanding or wall signs on properties or buildings for sale, lease, or rent not exceeding 24 square feet in area and nine feet in height. Such signs shall meet the minimum accessory structure setbacks or nine feet, whichever is less. No person shall place a temporary sign in a public right-of-way. The property owner shall remove all sale, lease, or rent signage within 10 days after they sell, lease, or rent the property.
- (2) Construction signage. Each property may contain up to 32 square feet of temporary signage when it is subject to an active building permit. Building permit placards and other government-ordered signage do not count towards this allowance.
- (3) Universal temporary board and banner signage.
 - (a) Residential properties. The City permits one temporary freestanding sign, not exceeding six square feet in area, provided that no such signs exceed four feet in height or lie within a public right-of-way. The City limits universal temporary signage to no more than 30 consecutive days two times in any calendar year. Common examples of temporary signage include yard sale, congratulatory postings, or notices of gatherings.
 - (b) Other properties.
 - [1] Temporary signs shall be approved by the Zoning Administrator.
 - [a] Churches, schools and institutions:
 - [i] Size: up to 32 square feet.
 - [ii] Height: maximum of eight feet.
 - [iii] Duration: limited to 30 consecutive days, limited to two times per year.
 - [b] Other uses:
 - [i] Business signs are limited to grand openings. Temporary promotional signs are prohibited except as related to sandwich board signs and window signs in Subsections G and H.
 - [ii] Size: up to 24 square feet.
 - [iii] Duration: limited to 30 consecutive days.
 - [iv] Mounting:
 - [A] Business banners must be securely mounted to stable structures, such as buildings or fences.
 - [B] Temporary signs affixed to single poles are prohibited.

- (c) Temporary signs shall not be illuminated.

- (d) Special event signs: Signage promoting an event shall not be displayed more than 30 days before the event is held or more than 10 days after the event was held.
- (4) Small permanent wall signage. The City permits small permanent wall signage that does not exceed two square feet in area and is mounted flush against a building.

[Is for directory/menu signs. Also can be for in-home businesses too.
 "Prohibited Signs" says "Signs for any R use except those specifically listed within Subsection G."

- (5) Interior and window signage. The City permits interior and inside-window signs intended for viewing from inside or outside the building, provided that such signs cover or obscure no more than 40% of the window's area.

[Could be applied to residential]

- (6) Election campaign signs. As provided in § 12.04, Wis. Stats., the City permits election campaign signs subject to the following requirements:
- (a) No person may erect an election campaign sign before the first day of the election campaign period as defined in the Wisconsin Statutes. The property owner shall remove any election campaign sign within 10 days following the election.
 - (b) Election campaign signs shall not exceed 11 square feet in area unless the sign is affixed to a permanent structure; does not extend beyond the perimeter of the structure; and does not obstruct a window, door, fire escape, ventilation shaft, or other area which is required by the City building code to remain unobstructed.
 - (c) No person shall place any election campaign sign within a public right-of-way nor so close to a pedestrian way as to hinder or endanger safe passage.

H. Signs permitted with a permit.

Table IV-1 Sign Regulations				
Sign Type	Number Allowed	Sign Area (Maximum)	Sign Height (Maximum, feet)	Where Allowed
Ground	1 per street yard	1 square foot per linear foot of lot frontage	10	Street yard
Wall	No maximum so long as the total square feet of signage per facade does not exceed 1 square foot per linear foot of building facade		N/A	Street-facing building facade

Projecting	1 per business	12 square feet	N/A	Within 6 feet of entrance
Wayfinding	No limit	6 square feet	5	No limit

Table IV-1 Sign Regulations				
Sign Type	Number Allowed	Sign Area (Maximum)	Sign Height (Maximum, feet)	Where Allowed
Sandwich Board	1 per building, business, or tenant space as applicable	12 square feet	4	Street yard or public sidewalk within 10 feet of business entrance

(1) Ground signs.

- (a) Setbacks. Property owners must set ground signs back from the right-of-way a distance equal to their height.

[discuss if too restrictive]

- (b) Grouping of uses. Property owners may group multiple uses within a single property on a single sign.

(2) Wall signs.

[Wall signs on strip malls- As written, narrow storefronts would not be allowed appropriate sized signs. Requires staff time to inventory all signs on strip malls to calculate what's left, but if vacancies, a new business cannot use the remaining allowable area.]

[MASTER SIGN PLAN- code does not address residential complexes and strip malls for a sign system]

- (a) Projections above roof line. Wall signs may not project above the roof line or eaves of a building.
- (b) Parking area. A facade which faces a customer parking area counts as street-facing building facade.

(3) Projecting signs.

- (a) Extension distance. Projecting signs may project no more than six feet into the public right-of-way and shall be at least 24 inches from the face of the street curb.

- (4) Sandwich board signs. Property owners must remove sandwich board signs from any sidewalk by 2:30 a.m. Signs on public ways. No person shall place, erect, or maintain a sign within the public right-of-way without City approval. Signs shall not obstruct pedestrian or vehicular visibility, interfere with traffic

control devices, or impede access to public infrastructure such as sidewalks, fire hydrants, utility poles, or drainage systems. Unauthorized signs placed in the public right-of-way are subject to immediate removal by the City without notice. The erection of any sign in the public way in the City of South Milwaukee shall be subject to the following regulations:

- (a) No signs shall be erected or painted in the public way until a written request has been submitted to the City Engineer providing:

- [1] The size of the sign.
- [2] The sign material and weight of the sign.
- [3] The method of supporting the sign.
- [4] The location of the sign shown on a site map.
- [5] The written consent of the owner of the building(s) if the request is made by someone other than the owner.

- (b) The City may remove any signs found in the public right-of-way in violation of this chapter at the property owner's expense.

I. Signs prohibited in any district. The City prohibits the following signs.

- (1) Abandoned signs.
- (2) A vehicle or trailer used exclusively as a sign or advertising device. No person shall park any such vehicle or trailer on a public right-of-way, on public property, or on private property to be visible from a public right-of-way. This provision does not prohibit vehicle signs customarily attached, lettered, or painted on a vehicle or trailer to identify the ownership or function of the vehicle.
- (3) Signs whose content violates any laws or regulations, including but not limited to the obscenity provisions of Chapter 944 of the Wisconsin Statutes.
- (4) Signs painted, attached, or affixed to trees or other living vegetation.
- (5) In multi-story or mixed-use buildings, wall or projecting signs on floors occupied by R uses.
[Discuss allowing if not illuminated if near window. Internal and external lighting allowed if 10-ft away from apartment unit. Also, relates to a master signage plan]
- (6) Signs for any R use except those specifically listed within Subsection G.
- (7) Permanent corrugated plastic signs and other materials intended for interior use.

J. Sign measurements.

- (1) Signable area. The signable area of a building is designated as the area of the facade of the building up to the roof line which is free of windows and doors or major architectural detail on which signs may be displayed. In computing signable area, any facade which faces or abuts a public right-of-way may be utilized. Calculations may include parapet walls, but shall exclude door and window openings.
- (2) Measuring sign face.

- (a) Area of copy. In calculating the area of a sign to determine whether it meets the requirement of this chapter, the Zoning Administrator shall include the sign copy and any border or frame surrounding that copy, but shall exclude supporting posts or foundations from the area calculation.
 - (b) Irregular shapes. The Zoning Administrator shall determine the area of irregularly shaped signs or signs containing two or more detached elements by measuring the area of the smallest regular polygon that will encompass all elements of the sign.
 - (c) Multi-sided signs. The Zoning Administrator shall use the area of only one side of a multi-sided sign if the sides are less than or equal to 30° from parallel of each other. If the sides are greater than 30° from parallel of each other, the Zoning Administrator shall count all sign faces towards the total sign area.
- (3) Measuring sign height. The Zoning Administrator shall calculate sign height by measuring the vertical distance from the normal grade at the base to the highest point of the sign structure. The Zoning Administrator shall set the normal grade as the lowest of:
- (a) The existing grade prior to construction;
 - (b) The newly established grade after construction, excluding any filling, berms, mounds, or excavating solely for locating the sign;
 - (c) The average elevation of the property within 100 feet of the sign location; and
 - (d) The average between the sign elevation and the centerline elevation of an adjacent public right-of-way within 100 feet of the sign location.



ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT MEMO

To: **Plan Commission**

From: **City Engineer Genevieve Stollenwerk**

Meeting Date: **March 24, 2026**

Subject: **Discussion on creating a standalone Stormwater Management Chapter and removing stormwater-related provisions from the zoning code.**

A. Background/Rationale

The current zoning code includes pre-construction and post-construction stormwater management requirements. Floodplain regulations and the stormwater utility are established under separate chapters. Illicit discharge provisions were previously included in the zoning code but are no longer part of the current code.

B. Key Issues for Consideration

Staff is proposing to reorganize stormwater-related regulations by creating a standalone Stormwater Management Chapter. This would include relocating existing erosion control and post-construction standards from the zoning code and reestablishing illicit discharge provisions within the new chapter. Staff is seeking feedback on removing these sections from zoning to create a more comprehensive and organized chapter.

C. Fiscal Impact

Potential consultant costs for ordinance review and drafting.

D. Requested Action

Discussion only. Provide feedback to staff on the proposed code reorganization.

E. Attachments

Draft Stormwater Management Code